

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

ALJUSTICE CORREA,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER
MIKE SUAREZ, POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER BOYCE, AND "JOHN DOES 1-5,"
PERSONS EMPLOYED BY THE CITY OF NEW
YORK,

Defendants.

To the above named Defendants:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the within verified complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on Plaintiff's attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of summons, exclusive of the day of service or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York; and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the notice set forth below and in the within verified complaint.

Dated: New York, New York
April 13, 2021

SUMMONS

Index No.: _____

Date Filed: _____

Plaintiff designates
Bronx County
as the place of trial

The basis of venue is based on
CPLR § 504(3)

/s/ Russ Kofman

Russ Kofman, Esq.
LEBEDIN KOFMAN, LLP
Attorneys for Plaintiff
ALJUSTICE CORREA
26 Broadway, 27th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 500-3273

Defendants' Addresses:

CITY OF NEW YORK, 100 CHURCH STREET, NEW YORK, NY 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, 1 POLICE PLAZA, NEW YORK, NY 10038

POLICE OFFICER MIKE SUAREZ OF PSA 7 SHIELD # 5841, POLICE SERVICE AREA 7,
737 MELROSE AVENUE, BRONX, NY 10455

POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER BOYCE OF PSA 7 SHIELD # 1500, POLICE SERVICE
AREA 7, 737 MELROSE AVENUE, BRONX, NY 10455

"JOHN DOES 1-5," PERSONS EMPLOYED BY THE CITY OF NEW YORK, 100 CHURCH
STREET, NEW YORK, NY 10007

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SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

ALJUSTICE CORREA,

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER
MIKE SUAREZ, POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER BOYCE, AND "JOHN DOES 1-5,"
PERSONS EMPLOYED BY THE CITY OF NEW
YORK,

Index No.:

Defendants.

ALJUSTICE CORREA, (hereinafter the "Plaintiff"), by his attorneys, LEBEDIN KOFMAN LLP, complaining against Defendants CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER MIKE SUAREZ, POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER BOYCE, AND "JOHN DOES 1-5," PERSONS EMPLOYED BY THE CITY OF NEW YORK, (hereinafter collectively "Defendants"), upon information and belief, alleges as follows:

INTRODUCTION

1. Plaintiff brings this action for compensatory damages and punitive damages under the common law of the State of New York, and for compensatory damages, punitive damages, and attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. §§ 1983 and 1988 for violation of his rights under the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.

Timeliness and Notice of Claim

2. Plaintiff filed a Notice of Claim in accordance with General Municipal Law Section 50-e and 50-I on or about March 6, 2020. The Notice of Claim set forth the name and address of

Plaintiff, his attorneys the nature of the claim, the time and place where it arose, and the items and amounts of damages claimed.

3. At least thirty (30) days has passed since service of the Notice of Claim, and payment of the claim has been either refused or neglected.

4. A General Municipal Law Section 50-h hearing was held on or about November 6, 2020.

5. This action is being commenced within one year of the dates of which all claims accrued and with the consideration of the toll by Governor Cuomo and filing suspension by Hon. marks.

6. Plaintiff has complied with all conditions precedent to maintain this action.

7. All state causes of action pleaded herein fall within one or more of the exceptions set forth in New York Civil Practice Law & Rules Section 1602 with respect to joint and several liability.

PARTIES

8. At all relevant times, Plaintiff was and is a resident of Bronx County, City and State of New York.

9. At all relevant times, Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK (hereinafter the “City”) was and is a municipal corporation incorporated and existing under the laws of the State of New York.

10. At all relevant times, Defendant NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT (hereinafter “NYPD”) was and is an agency of Defendant City.

11. At all relevant times, Defendant City operated, controlled and managed Defendant NYPD.

12. At all relevant times, Defendant POLICE MIKE SUAREZ, Shield No. 5841 (hereinafter “PO Suarez”) was an officer, agent, and/or employee of Defendant City.

13. At all relevant times, Defendant DETECTIVE CHRISTOPHER BOYCE, Shield No. 1500 (hereinafter “PO Boyce”) was an officer, agent, and/or employee of Defendant City.

14. At all relevant times, the names of Defendants “JOHN DOES 1-5” (hereinafter the “Officers”) are fictitious, and are intended to be individuals engaged in law enforcement, who were involved in the arrest of Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff’s rights, whose names are presently unknown to Plaintiff.

15. At all relevant times, Defendant Officers were officers, agents and/or employees of Defendant City.

16. At all relevant times, Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers were each individually hired, trained, supervised and retained by Defendant City, including its agencies, and all supervisory officers, agents, employees, and/or contractors of Defendant City.

17. At all relevant times, Defendants were involved in violating Plaintiff’s rights, and individuals who acted in concert with them, acted or failed to act, as alleged herein, toward Plaintiff under color of the statutes, ordinances, customs, policies, procedures, rules, and/or usage of the State and City of New York, and within the scope of their employment.

18. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers are sued herein in both their individual and official capacities.

FACTS

19. The facts alleged in this complaint are based upon the personal observations of Plaintiff regarding events that took place in his presence, and upon information and belief, the sources thereof are documents prepared in connection with the arrest of Plaintiff and public documents and information relating thereto which are presently available to Plaintiff. The aforesaid documentary evidence is presently incomplete, as it does not include numerous documents and exhibits; therefore, the complaint has been prepared without the benefit of full discovery.

The Incident of January 14, 2020

20. On or about January 14, 2020, at or near 484 East 139th Street, in the County of Bronx, State of New York, at approximately 11:00 p.m., Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers wrongfully and unlawfully searched, seized, and arrested Plaintiff by Defendants, their agents, servants, and/or employees, without probable cause or justification and charged with PL § 220.16(01) Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the Third Degree, PL § 220.06(01) Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the Fifth Degree, and PL § 220.03 Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance in the Seventh Degree (hereinafter the “Arrest”).

21. At the time of the subject arrest, Plaintiff was lawfully walking on the sidewalk, posing no immediate threat to the safety of self or others.

22. While Plaintiff was lawfully on the sidewalk, individuals known to Plaintiff were driving by in a red Ford Expedition and stopped to converse with Plaintiff.

23. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers approached Plaintiff in an unmarked van while Plaintiff was still lawfully standing on the sidewalk conversing with friends

posing no threat.

24. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers without probable cause or justification, approached Plaintiff and forcefully pushed Plaintiff onto the Ford Expedition.

25. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers directed the owner of the Ford Expedition to open the back door and then Defendants forcefully pushed Plaintiff into the back seat of the Ford Expedition.

26. Plaintiff was transferred to PSA 7 where he was strip searched.

27. Furthermore, Plaintiff had a cast on his left pinky from an unrelated incident, and Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers negligently and forcefully peeled off the cast during the strip search causing excacerbated injuries.

28. Defendant PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers did not find anything on Plaintiff's person during the strip search.

29. Plaintiff requested medical attention for his left pinky, but was denied medical treatment while at the precinct and Central Bookings. Defendants' denial of medical treatment caused additional damage to Plaintiff's left pinky, and severely compromised his recovery on the left pinky.

30. Defendants wrongfully commenced prosecution against Plaintiff without probable cause or justification under Docket No.: 2020BX001273. On or about March 3, 2021, the Bronx County Criminal Court dismissed and sealed all charges against Plaintiff.

31. Additionally, Plaintiff has been harassed, wrongfully arrested, and taunted by Officers of PSA 7 and continues to be unlawfully stopped, searched, and seized by Defendants and their Officers.

32. Defendants' actions and/or omissions caused Plaintiff to be wrongfully incarcerated for a period of approximately twenty-four (24) hours and make appearances in court to defend himself against the aforesaid wrongful charges.

33. Defendant's actions and/or omissions caused Plaintiff to spend copious amounts of out-of-pocket expenses, including but not limited to bail and legal fees for his criminal defense.

34. At all times relevant to this action, Defendants acted intentionally, willfully, knowingly, negligently, and with reckless disregard for, and deliberate indifference to the rights of Plaintiff.

35. The acts of Defendants prior to and during the course of the Arrest of Plaintiff were the direct result of the failure of Defendant City to properly hire, train, supervise, monitor, and discipline its officers, agents, employees and/or contractors.

36. The acts of Defendants prior to and during the course of the Arrest of Plaintiff were the direct result of policies, practices, and customs developed, implemented, enforced, encouraged, sanctioned, or tolerated by Defendant City.

37. As a result of the aforesaid acts or omissions of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained personal, physical, and emotional injuries and losses including, loss of enjoyment of life, loss of liberty, emotional distress, mental anguish, trauma, shock, fear, humiliation, embarrassment, shame, indignity, damage to his reputation, professional and economic losses, and financial costs and expenses.

38. The amount of damages sought in this action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts that may otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSES OF ACTION
STATE CLAIMS
AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION
AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS FOR
FALSE ARREST AND IMPRISONMENT

39. The allegations set forth in paragraphs “1” through “38” inclusive are incorporated herein as if fully set forth.

40. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers intended to cause the wrongful and unlawful prosecution of Plaintiff, and wrongfully and unlawfully imprisoned Plaintiff.

41. Defendants intended to restrain or to cause Plaintiff to be restrained and to be deprived of his liberty, and caused him to be taken into police custody, and charged with crimes he did not commit.

42. Defendants knew, or should have known, that the conduct engaged in would result in the wrongful and unlawful arrest and imprisonment of Plaintiff.

43. Plaintiff was aware of such confinement by Defendants and did not consent to said confinement.

44. The aforementioned confinement was not privileged in any way and was without legal justification.

45. Plaintiff was thereafter caused to be incarcerated for approximately twenty-four (24) hours.

46. Defendants City is responsible and liable for the acts of Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers done within the scope of their employment under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

47. As a direct and proximate cause of Defendants' acts and / or omissions, Plaintiff was caused to suffer great pain and mental anguish, psychological and emotional suffering, great humiliation and fear, and further pecuniary damages and legal costs in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limitation of all lower courts and in an amount to be determined at a trial of this action.

48. The conduct of Defendants set forth above and complained of herein exhibited such a high degree of moral culpability that it renders Defendants liable to Plaintiff for punitive damages.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION
AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS FOR
NEGLIGENT / INTENTIONAL INFLICTION OF EMOTIONAL DISTRESS

49. The allegations set forth in paragraphs "1" through "48" inclusive are incorporated herein as if fully set forth.

50. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct throughout the course of the Arrest of Plaintiff.

51. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers caused Plaintiff to fear for his safety during the course of the aforesaid extreme and outrageous conduct.

52. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers knew, or should have known, that the extreme and outrageous conduct engaged in would result in injury to Plaintiff.

53. Said extreme and outrageous conduct exceeded all bounds usually tolerated by a decent society.

54. The aforesaid extreme and outrageous conduct was performed with the intent to cause, or disregard of a substantial probability of causing severe emotional distress to Plaintiff.

55. Such extreme and outrageous conduct caused Plaintiff to suffer severe and debilitating mental anguish and emotional distress which had a disabling effect on Plaintiff.

56. Defendants City is responsible for and liable for the acts of Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers done within the scope of their employment through the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

57. As a direct and proximate cause of Defendants' intentional infliction of emotional distress of Plaintiff, Plaintiff was caused to suffer great pain and mental anguish, great humiliation and fear, and further pecuniary damages and legal costs in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limitation of all lower courts and in an amount to be determined at a trial of this action.

58. The conduct of Defendants set forth above and complained of herein exhibited such a high degree of moral culpability that it renders the Defendants liable to Plaintiff for punitive damages.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS FOR
MALICIOUS PROSECUTION

59. The allegations set forth in paragraphs "1" through "58" inclusive are incorporated herein as if fully set forth.

60. Defendants, acting with malice, arrested Plaintiff and initiated criminal proceedings against him despite knowing that Plaintiff had committed no crime.

61. Defendants knew that there was no probable cause to commence or continue criminal proceedings against Plaintiff, and that his arrest was based entirely on false and spurious charges lodged by Defendants.

62. In reliance upon the deliberately false and perjured reports of the Defendants, and by reason of the withholding by Defendants of the true facts relating to Plaintiff's innocence, Plaintiff was arrested and the District Attorney's Office prosecuted him.

63. All criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor and all charges against him were dismissed and sealed.

64. As a direct and proximate result of Defendants' malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, Plaintiff was caused to suffer loss of liberty, and severe physical, psychological, and economic injuries in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limitation of all lower courts and in an amount to be determined at a trial of this action.

65. The conduct of Defendants set forth above and complained of herein exhibited such a high degree of moral culpability that it evinces a conscious disregard for the rights of others and renders the Defendants liable to Plaintiff for punitive damages

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION
AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS FOR
NEGLIGENT HIRING, TRAINING, RETENTION AND SUPERVISION

66. The allegations set forth in paragraphs "1" through "65" inclusive are incorporated herein as if fully set forth.

67. That Defendants City failed to exercise reasonable care in hiring, training, retaining, and supervising Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers; thereby, breaching its duty to Plaintiff as well as to the public, to exercise reasonable care in their hiring, training, retaining, and supervising employees.

68. That Defendants City was aware of and should have known of the propensity of Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers to commit injurious acts.

69. That Defendants City was negligent in failing to properly train and supervise its employees, more specifically Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers.

70. Defendants City is responsible and liable for the acts of Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers done within the scope of their employment under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

71. As a result of Defendants' actions, Plaintiff was caused to suffer significant, severe, painful and permanent personal injuries, psychological and emotional suffering, humiliation, embarrassment and fear, all of which continue until this day in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limitation of all lower courts and in an amount to be determined at a trial of this action.

72. The conduct of Defendants set forth above and complained of herein exhibited such a high degree of moral culpability that it renders Defendants liable to Plaintiff for punitive damages.

AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS FOR
NEGLIGENCE / GROSS NEGLIGENCE

73. The allegations set forth in paragraphs "1" through "72" inclusive are incorporated herein as if fully set forth.

74. Defendants' acts and / or omissions in causing the aforesaid false arrest and imprisonment; assault and battery; malicious prosecution of Plaintiff; negligent hiring, retention, training, and supervision of its employees, officers, agents, and / or contractors; negligent medical treatment and care; and negligent infliction of emotion distress were in breach of the duty of due care owed to Plaintiff.

75. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers acted negligently and in disregard for the procedures and safeguards, which are the standard for the arrest of a citizen, in arresting Plaintiff in the absence of reasonable suspicion or probable cause. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers further breached their duty of care to investigate before affecting the seizure of a citizen and in their continued prosecution of Plaintiff.

76. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers acted negligently and in disregard for the procedures and safeguards, which are the standard for the medical treatment of a citizen, in treating Plaintiff during his period of incarceration. Defendants City and NYPD acted negligently in their hiring, retention, training, and supervision of their employees, agents, and / or contractors.

77. That Defendant City is responsible and liable for the acts of Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers done within the scope of their employment under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

78. As a direct and proximate cause of Defendants' negligence, Plaintiff was caused to suffer significant, severe, painful and permanent personal injuries, psychological and emotional suffering, humiliation, embarrassment and fear, all of which continue until this day in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limitation of all lower courts and in an amount to be determined at a trial of this action.

79. The conduct of Defendants set forth above and complained of herein exhibited such a high degree of moral culpability that it renders Defendants liable to Plaintiff for punitive damages.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION
AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS FOR
NEGLIGENT HIRING, TRAINING, RETENTION AND SUPERVISION

80. Plaintiff repeats and re-alleges and incorporates by reference the allegations in paragraphs “1” through “79” above with the same force and effect as if herein set forth.

81. That Defendants with malicious intent, arrested Plaintiff and initiated criminal proceedings despite the knowledge that Plaintiff had committed no crime.

82. That all charges against Plaintiff have been dismissed.

83. That there was no probable cause for the arrests and criminal proceedings. That by reason of Defendants’ acts and omissions, Defendants, acting under the color of state law and within the scope of their authority, in gross and wanton disregard of Plaintiff’s rights, deprived Plaintiff of his liberty when they maliciously prosecuted him and subjected him to unlawful, illegal and excessive detentions, in violation of his rights pursuant to the New York State Constitution.

84. That upon information and belief, Defendants had a policy and/or custom of maliciously prosecuting individuals despite the lack of probable cause. Thus, as a result of the above described policies and customs, Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted despite the fact that he had committed no violation of the law.

85. That upon information and belief, the policy and/or custom of Defendant City to inadequately hire, train, supervise, discipline and/or terminate their officers, staff, agents and employees, thereby failing to adequately discourage further constitutional violations on the part of their officers, staff, agents, and employees.

86. That as a result of the above described policies and customs, Defendant City, its staff, agents and employees of Defendant City believe that their actions would not be properly

monitored by supervisory officers and that misconduct would not be investigated or sanctioned, but would be tolerated.

87. That the above described policies and customs demonstrate a deliberate indifference on the part of the policymakers of Defendant City to the constitutional rights of arrestees and were the cause of the violations of Plaintiff's rights alleged herein.

88. That in so acting, Defendant City abused its power and authority as policymaker of Defendant NYPD under the color of State and/or local law.

89. That upon information and belief, in 2020, Defendant City had a policy or routine practice of alleging facts against persons for the purpose of charging crimes they did not commit.

90. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical and psychological injuries, traumatic stress, post-traumatic stress disorder, mental anguish, economic damages including attorney's fees, damage to reputation, shame, humiliation, and indignity. All of said injuries may be permanent.

FEDERAL CLAIMS
FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION
MUNICIPAL LIABILITY "MONELL" CLAIM

91. Plaintiff repeats and re-alleges and incorporates by reference the allegations in paragraphs 1 through 90 above with the same force and effect as if herein set forth.

92. Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers, individually and collectively, within the scope of their employment and authority and under color of State Law, engaged in conduct that constituted customs, policies, procedures, rules, or usages of the City and which were in violation of the rights, privileges, and immunities of Plaintiff, a citizen of the United States and resident of the State of New York, as secured by the United States Constitution.

93. The aforesaid customs, policies, procedures, rules, or usages included but were not limited to: failure to properly investigate before effecting an arrest; utilizing unnecessary and excessive force; failure to ensure that use of force by police officers is properly reported and investigated; failure to appropriately discipline police officers who utilize unnecessary and excessive force, as well as those who supervise said officers; failure to implement measures to ensure that officers are appropriately supervised by qualified and well-trained staff; and failure to intervene when employees, officers, agents, and/or contractors violate well-established statutory and constitutional rights.

94. The aforesaid unlawful policies and practices in tolerating such misconduct resulted in the subject Arrest rendering Defendant City liable to Plaintiff pursuant to Monell v. City of New York, 436 U.S. 658 (1978), and under 42 U.S.C. §1983.

95. The aforesaid conduct was consistent with the institutionalized practices of Defendant NYPD, which were known and previously sanctioned by Defendant City.

96. Despite knowledge of the institutionalized practices of Defendant NYPD, Defendant City took no effective actions to end or prevent such practices.

97. Defendant City had prior notice of the injurious actions and practices of Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers but took no effective actions to end or prevent the aforesaid Defendants from committing such practices.

98. Defendant City had prior notice that Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers had inadequate training regarding the applicable provisions of the Penal Law of the State of New York, Departmental policy, other applicable laws and federal and state statutory and

constitutional protections, but took no effective actions to ensure that the aforesaid Defendants were provided with adequate or appropriate training.

99. Defendant City authorized, tolerated, and ratified the misconduct of employees, officers, agents, and/or contractors, and of Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers, specifically, by failing to: discipline employees, officers and agents; take adequate precautions in screening, hiring, educating, informing, training, supervising, promoting, and retaining employees, officers, and agents; and failing to establish and maintain a meaningful system for responding to complaint of misconduct, all of which constitute deliberate indifference by Defendant City to Plaintiff's rights secured by the United States Constitution, and deliberate indifference to the physical safety and well-being of Plaintiff.

100. As a direct and proximate cause of Defendants' acts and/or omissions, Plaintiff was caused to suffer great pain and mental anguish, great humiliation and fear, and further pecuniary damages and legal costs in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limitation of all lower courts and in an amount to be determined at a trial of this action.

101. The conduct of Defendants set forth above and complained of herein exhibited such a high degree of moral culpability that it renders Defendant City liable to Plaintiff for punitive damages.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION
PURSUANT to 42 U.S.C. § 1983 (FALSE ARREST)

102. Plaintiff repeats and re-alleges and incorporates by reference the allegations in paragraphs 1 through 101 above with the same force and effect as if herein set forth.

103. At all times relevant herein the conduct of the Defendants were subject to 42 U.S.C. §§ 1983, 1985, 1986, and 1988.

104. The detention and arrest of Plaintiff without probable cause and without a lawful warrant was an abuse of power that constituted a seizure within the meaning of the Fourth Amendment of the United States Constitution and was an act taken by Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers with a deliberate indifference to Plaintiff's rights and privileges. The seizure and deprivation of Plaintiff's liberty was unreasonable and without due process of law, in violation of the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.

105. Acting under the color of law, Defendants achieved a denial of Plaintiff's rights, privileges or immunities secured by the United States Constitution or by Federal law, to wit:

- a. By depriving Plaintiff of his liberty without due process of law, by taking Plaintiff into custody and holding him there against Plaintiff's will.
- b. By making an unreasonable search and seizure of Plaintiff's property without due process of law.
- c. By conspiring for the purpose of impeding and hindering the due course of justice, with intent to deny Plaintiff equal protection of laws.
- d. By refusing or neglecting to prevent such deprivations and denials to Plaintiff thereby depriving Plaintiff of the rights, privileges, and immunities as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States.

106. Defendant City negligently trained Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers.

107. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical and psychological injuries, traumatic stress, post-traumatic stress disorder, mental anguish, economic damages

including attorney's fees, damages to reputation, shame, humiliation, and indignity. All of said injuries may be permanent.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
PURSUANT to 42 U.S.C. § 1983 (DETENTION AND CONFINEMENT)

108. Plaintiff repeats and re-alleges and incorporates by reference the allegations in paragraphs 1 through 107 above with the same force and effect as if herein set forth.

109. As a result of Defendants' concerted unlawful and malicious detention and confinement of Plaintiff, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of both his right to liberty without due process of law and his right to equal protection of the laws, and the due course of justice was impeded in violation of the Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments of the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C. 1983.

110. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical and psychological injuries, traumatic stress, post-traumatic stress disorder, mental anguish, economic damages including attorney's fees, damages to reputation, shame, humiliation, and indignity. All of said injuries may be permanent.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION
PURSUANT to 42 U.S.C. § 1983 (REFUSING OR NEGLECTING TO PREVENT)

111. Plaintiff repeats and re-alleges and incorporates by reference the allegations in paragraphs 1 through 110 above with the same force and effect as if herein set forth.

112. At all times relevant to the complaint, Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers, as police officers of Defendant NYPD were acting under the direction and control of Defendant City.

113. Acting under the color of law and pursuant to official policy Defendants PO Suarez, PO Boyce, and Officers, Defendant NYPD and Defendant City knowingly, recklessly and/or with gross negligence failed to instruct, supervise, control, and discipline on a continuing basis Defendant policy officers in their duties to refrain from:

- a. Unlawfully and maliciously harassing a citizen who was acting in accordance with his constitutional and statutory rights, privileges, and immunities;
- b. Unlawfully and maliciously arresting, imprisoning, and prosecuting a citizen who was acting in accordance with his constitutional and statutory rights, privileges, and immunities;
- c. Conspiring to violate the rights, privileges, and immunities guaranteed to Plaintiff by the Constitution and the laws of the United States and the laws of the State of New York;
- d. Otherwise depriving Plaintiff of his constitutional and statutory rights, privileges and immunities.

114. Defendant City had knowledge of or had they diligently exercised their duties to instruct, supervise, control, and discipline on a continuing basis, should have had knowledge that the wrongs conspired to be done, as heretofore alleged, were about to be committed. Defendant City had the power to prevent or aid in preventing the commission of said wrongs, could have done so by reasonable diligence, and knowingly, recklessly, or with gross negligence failed or refused to do so.

115. Defendants City and Defendant NYPD directly or indirectly under color of law approved or ratified the unlawful deliberate, malicious, reckless, and wanton conduct of Defendant Officers heretofore described.

116. As a direct and proximate cause of the negligent and intentional acts of Defendants City and Defendant NYPD as set forth in paragraphs 1 to 115 above, Plaintiff suffered physical injury, loss of income, and severe mental anguish in connection with the deprivations of his constitutional and statutory rights guaranteed by the Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments of the Constitution of the United States and protected by 42 U.S.C. § 1983.

117. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical and psychological injuries, traumatic stress, post-traumatic stress disorder, mental anguish, economic damages including attorney's fees, damage to reputation, shame, humiliation, and indignity. All of the said injuries may be permanent.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
PURSUANT to 42 U.S.C. § 1983 (MALICIOUS PROSECUTION)

118. Plaintiff repeats and re-alleges and incorporates by reference the allegations in paragraphs 1 through 117 above with the same force and effect as if herein set forth.

119. That Defendants with malicious intent, arrested Plaintiff and initiated criminal proceedings despite the knowledge that Plaintiff had committed no crime.

120. That all charges against Plaintiff have been dismissed.

121. That there was no probable cause for the arrests and criminal proceedings. That by reason of Defendants' acts and omissions, Defendants, acting under the color of state law and within the scope of their authority, in gross and wanton disregard of Plaintiff's rights, deprived

Plaintiff of his liberty when they maliciously prosecuted him and subjected him to unlawful, illegal and excessive detentions, in violation of his rights pursuant to the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.

122. That upon information and belief, Defendants had a policy and/or custom of maliciously prosecuting individuals despite the lack of probable cause. Thus, as a result of the above described policies and customs, Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted despite the fact that he had committed no violation of the law.

123. That upon information and belief, the policy and/or custom of Defendant City to inadequately hire, train, supervise, discipline and/or terminate their officers, staff, agents and employees, thereby failing to adequately discourage further constitutional violations on the part of their officers, staff, agents, and employees.

124. That as a result of the above described policies and customs, Defendant City, its staff, agents and employees of Defendant City believe that their actions would not be properly monitored by supervisory officers and that misconduct would not be investigated or sanctioned, but would be tolerated.

125. That the above described policies and customs demonstrate a deliberate indifference on the part of the policymakers of Defendant City to the constitutional rights of arrestees and were the cause of the violations of Plaintiff's rights alleged herein.

126. That in so acting, Defendant City abused its power and authority as policymaker of Defendant NYPD under the color of State and/or local law.

127. That upon information and belief, in 2020, Defendant City had a policy or routine practice of alleging facts against persons for the purpose of charging crimes they did not commit.

128. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical and psychological injuries, traumatic stress, post-traumatic stress disorder, mental anguish, economic damages including attorney's fees, damage to reputation, shame, humiliation, and indignity. All of said injuries may be permanent.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against Defendants CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER MIKE SUAREZ, POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER BOYCE, AND "JOHN DOES 1-5," PERSONS EMPLOYED BY THE CITY OF NEW YORK, individually and collectively, on all causes of action, in an amount which exceeds the jurisdiction limitations of all lower courts and in an amount to be determined at the trial of this action, together with all costs and interest, and for such other relief as this Court may deem just and proper.

Dated: New York, New York
April 13, 2021

/s/ Russ Kofman
Russ Kofman, Esq.
LEBEDIN KOFMAN, LLP
Attorneys for Plaintiff
ALJUSTICE CORREA
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New York, New York 10004
T: (212) 500-3273
F: (855) 696-6848
E: info@lebedinkofmanlaw.com

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

I, the undersigned, am an attorney duly admitted to practice law in the courts of the State of New York, and affirm the following to be true:

I am a member of Lebedin Kofman, LLP, the attorneys of record for Plaintiff.

I have read the foregoing Complaint, and know the allegations of fact stated therein, that the stated allegations of fact are true to my own knowledge except as to those allegations stated to be on information and belief, and as to those matters, I believe them to be true.

The grounds of my belief as to all matters stated to be upon information and belief are conversations with Plaintiff, my review of the documents contained in files maintained by my office in connection with this matter, and any investigation of the relevant facts and circumstances.

The reason I make this verification instead of Plaintiff is that Plaintiff is not presently within the county where Lebedin Kofman, LLP maintains its offices.

Dated: New York, New York
April 13, 2021

/s/ Russ Kofman
Russ Kofman, Esq.